

SAMUEL ACUÑA

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Summary

Passionate leader, thinker, and doer that thrives on creating digital products that inspire and provide value. Recently acquired a patent and previously featured in a marketing recruiting video.

Professional Experience

Senior Staff Design Engineer – Visa Austin, TX (Jun 2022 – present)

- Lead theming implementation for the Visa Product Design System (VPDS)
- Planned and designed the new infrastructure architecture for the latest version of VPDS
- Lead Gen AI implementation for component code generation across libraries and technologies
- Lead AI Enablement effort including Design MCP server and data standardization across Design teams including design engineering, design guidelines, content standards, and accessibility requirements.

Staff Design Engineer – Visa Austin, TX (Nov 2019 – Jun 2022)

- Expanded products and assets offered by VPDS including the Styles library, Theming, and Layouts.
- Contributed to library development across multiple technologies including SCSS, React, and Angular with full accessibility implementation and testing.
- Co-developed and received a patent for a payment integrated travel journaling engine.

📄 Patent No. US11244016B2, filed June 2018, granted February 2022.

Senior Design Engineer – Visa Austin, TX (Nov 2017 – Nov 2019)

- Lead the web library for VPDS including implementation of component design specs, accessibility and testing.
- Contributed to Stencil, React, and Angular component libraries, as well as the Data Visualization charts library.

Design Engineer – Visa Austin, TX (Dec 2014 – Nov 2017)

- Front-end development of RESTful SPAs and dashboard applications using technologies such as React, d3, SASS, Bootstrap, and Material UI.

Student Technician – Digital Media Institute Austin, TX (Jan 2014 – Aug 2015)

- Back-end developer of Environ video game using C# in Unity. Also designed and developed an application to track and visualize (d3) how users interact with the game.

Explorations

gulp-axe-cli Austin, TX (Aug 2018 - present)

Develop and maintain open source project that uses axe with gulp to test for accessibility in a CI/CD context.

Perspective Austin, TX (Aug 2015 - Dec 2019)

Designed and developed contextual surveying tool to collect feedback on UI, UX, and app/site content.

DMI Bootcamp Austin, TX (May 2013 - Jun 2013)

Collaborated on projects and got exposed to web frameworks like Django and Bootstrap.

3-Day Startup Austin, TX (Oct 2012)

Developed a site for an education startup. 🏆 Award received for best “wired-in” coder.

Education

The University of Texas at Austin Austin, TX (proj. Feb 2025)

Post Graduate Program in Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning: Business Applications; McCombs

The University of Texas at Austin Austin, TX (Dec 2014)

BSA in Computer Science, BA in Philosophy, Linguistics minor